STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

RMA Process SOP

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Audience	Customer Care, Technical Support, Returns Processing Center staff
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Purpose. Defines how Return Merchandise Authorizations (RMAs) are created, how returned units are received, inspected and graded at the Returns Processing Center (RPC), and how RMAs are closed.

1. RMA Types

Type	Used for	Created by	Outcome after inspection
RET	Returns for refund within the return window	Tier 1	Refund per LHS-SOP-CC-004
WAR	Warranty claims - standard replacement	Tier 2	Replacement ships
ADV	Warranty claims - advance replacement	Tier 2	Card hold released
DOA	Device dead on arrival, reported within 14 days of delivery	Tier 1 or Tier 2	Replacement ships by expedited shipping at no cost

Table 1-1. RMA types.

2. RMA Numbers and Validity

RMA numbers use the format RMA-YYMM-NNNNN, where YYMM is the year and month of creation and NNNNN is a sequence number, for example RMA-2603-00417. An RMA is valid for 30 days from creation. The customer must ship the item within 14 days; RMAs with no carrier scan after 14 days receive an automatic reminder email, and RMAs still open after 30 days are cancelled automatically.

Only one RMA may be open per serial number. If a customer needs to change the RMA type (for example from RET to WAR), cancel the open RMA and create a new one rather than editing the type.

3. Creating an RMA

1. Open the order or the device record in OMS and select Create RMA.

2. Choose the RMA type from Table 1-1 and the reason code from the Returns and Refunds SOP or the warranty claim.
3. Enter the serial number of every unit being returned. OMS rejects serial numbers that do not belong to the order or account.
4. Select the return method: prepaid label (default), carrier pickup (bulk RMAs only) or battery return kit (see section 7).
5. Add the LumoraDesk ticket number and save. OMS emails the RMA number and packing instructions to the customer.

3.1 Bulk RMAs

RMAs for 10 or more units on one account, typically from installers or property managers, require approval from the Operations Manager before the RMA is released. Bulk RMAs ship by freight pickup on a pallet, scheduled by the RPC within 3 business days of approval.

4. Receiving at the RPC

1. Scan the RMA number on the package label. Packages must be logged in OMS within 1 business day of arrival at the RPC.
2. Open the package and compare the serial number on each unit with the serial numbers on the RMA.
3. Inspect and grade each unit within 3 business days of arrival (section 5).
4. Record the grade and disposition in OMS. This triggers the outcome in Table 1-1 automatically within 1 business day.

4.1 Exceptions at Receiving

Exception	Handling
Serial number does not match the RMA	Place the unit on hold and ask Customer Care to contact the customer. If the discrepancy is not resolved within 5 business days, process the RMA as not received and return the unit to the customer.
Package arrives without an RMA number	Move to the quarantine shelf for 10 business days while Customer Care tries to identify the sender. Unidentified units are then scrapped and recorded as unclaimed.
Wrong product received	Hold the item and contact the customer; the RMA stays open until the correct item arrives or the RMA expires.
Visible battery swelling or leak	Stop handling. Move the package to the hazardous materials cabinet and notify the RPC supervisor immediately.

Table 4-1. Receiving exceptions.

5. Inspection and Grading

Inspectors power on every unit on the test bench, confirm it connects to the test network, run the automated self-test and check for physical damage, liquid indicators and missing parts. Each unit receives one grade:

Grade	Criteria	Disposition
A	Unopened, or opened with all parts and no signs of use	RTS - return to stock as new
B	Opened, complete, passes self-test, minor signs of use	RFB - refurbish and sell as Certified Refurbished
C	Missing parts or cosmetic damage, passes self-test	RFB, or harvest for parts if refurbishing is not economical
D	Fails self-test, physical or liquid damage	SCR - scrap and recycle; RTV - return to vendor if defect rate tracking applies

Table 5-1. Inspection grades and dispositions.

Units returned under a WAR or ADV RMA that fail the self-test are recorded as confirmed defects. Units that pass the self-test with no fault found are graded normally, and the result is added to the warranty claim record.

6. Closing an RMA

- RET: the refund is released in OMS within 1 business day of the inspection result; Customer Care confirms the amount to the customer.
- WAR: the replacement is picked, packed and shipped within 2 business days of receipt.
- ADV: the card authorization hold is released; if the unit is not received within 21 days of the replacement delivery the card is charged.
- DOA: the replacement ships by expedited shipping the same business day when the RMA is created before 12:00 PM Eastern, without waiting for the return.

7. Returning Devices With Batteries

The Thermostat T3 contains a lithium-ion battery. A T3 that is reported with a swollen, hot or leaking battery must not be shipped with a standard prepaid label. Instead, select the return method Battery Return Kit when creating the RMA. The RPC sends kit BRK-1, a fire-resistant pouch with a hazardous-materials label, by ground shipping within 2 business days, and the customer must not return the device until the kit arrives. Undamaged T3 units and all other products ship normally.

8. Performance Targets

Metric	Target
Dock to logged in OMS	1 business day
Dock to inspected and graded	3 business days
Dock to stock (Grade A)	5 business days
RMAs open longer than 30 days	0 (auto-cancelled)

Table 8-1. RPC performance targets.

The RPC supervisor reviews the targets weekly with Returns Operations. Grade D rates above 8% for any product in a calendar month are reported to Product Engineering as a possible quality issue.

9. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Customer Care (Tier 1)	Creates RET and DOA RMAs, sends labels, answers customer questions about RMA status.
Technical Support (Tier 2)	Creates WAR and ADV RMAs after an approved warranty claim; manages card holds for ADV.
RPC receiving clerk	Logs packages, verifies serial numbers, handles receiving exceptions.
RPC inspector	Runs the test bench, grades units and records dispositions.
RPC supervisor	Hazardous materials handling, weekly target review, approval of scrap batches.
Operations Manager	Approves bulk RMAs and exceptions to this SOP.

Table 9-1. RMA roles.

9.1 Answering RMA Status Questions

Agents can see the RMA status in OMS: Created, Label Sent, In Transit, Received, Inspected, Closed or Cancelled. If a customer asks why a refund or replacement has not arrived, check the status first. Received but not inspected after 3 business days is a breach of the RPC target and should be reported to the RPC supervisor queue rather than promised to the customer as a date.